2. Languages of Burma, 1811 (*Classical Journal*, ‘Numbers in 200 Tongues’, No. 535, London: 1811, p. 107)

Three in the Burmah Empire.

Rooinga	*????*	*Banga*	*Myanman or Burmah*	*A few Chrisitans in Siam or Taimay*	*Taiyay*	*Tailong*
1 awg	aik	ak	teet	noong	noo	aning
2 doo	doo	de	hueet	so	sang	sonng
3 teen	teen	teen	thoum	sam	sam	sam
4 tchair	tsar	sa-ree	lay	see	shee	shee
5 pan-so-ee	paus	pas	ngaw	haw	haaw	haw
6 saw	tso	tsoe	kiouk	hoc	hook	hook
7 sat	sat	hat	kuhneet	kyaet	sayt	seet
8 aw-ton	as-to	awt	sheet	payt	payt	paet
9 no-naw	no	no	ko	ka-wo	kaw	kau
10 dus-so-a	dos	dos	tazay	seet	sheet	ship
20						
100						

An 1815 German compendium of languages of the wider region by J.S. Vateri also mentions the existence of the Rohingyas as an ethnic group (in this case spelt as ‘Ruinga’) with a distinct language.[45]

Thus there is plentiful evidence for the existence of the Rohingyas in Arakan by the early nineteenth century in a sequence of works published at the time. None of these sources had any partial political interest in the ethnic makeup of the region: none of them had any reason to invent the existence of a group such as the Rohingyas any more than they had an interest in suppressing such groups, and all clearly point to the fact that there was a major ethnic group in the region with a distinct language at the time, clearly identifiable as the Rohingyas. Notably, all three (Buchanan, Vateri and the *Classical Journal*) were produced during the brief period of Burmese control between 1784 and 1824, a time when other evidence points to an outflow of Muslims fleeing persecution.[46]

By the late eighteenth century, the Konbaung Dynasty of the central Burmese Kingdom had been strengthened by success in its wars with Siam.[47] Taking advantage of the weakness of the Bengali kingdom, it expanded into Arakan. One motivation for the Burmese attack was to ensure the Buddhist purity of Arakan and to reduce what were seen as